Project: Worked examples
Title: Mechanism kinematics
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## 1. Scope and method

A single-degree-of-freedom planar mechanism driven at constant speed: a four-bar linkage or an offset slider-crank (both circuits, position, velocity and acceleration over a sweep of the input angle, Grashof class, transmission angle against a minimum, toggle and dead-centre positions, loop-closure residual, input torque by virtual work), or a cam with a translating follower. Rigid links, no clearance, no friction.

| WHAT IT CALCULATES | RELATION |
|---|---|
| Four-bar position | $a\cdot e^{j\theta_2} + b\cdot e^{j\theta_3} = d + c\cdot e^{j\theta_4}$; $\ell = \lvert A - O_4\rvert$, $\cos\gamma = (c^2 + \ell^2 - b^2)/(2c\ell)$, $\theta_4 = \varphi \mp \gamma$ ($\varphi$ the direction $O_4\to A$; open: −, crossed: +); $\theta_3$ from B − A |
| Four-bar velocity and acceleration | differentiated loop, 2×2 system with det = $b\cdot c\cdot\sin(\theta_3 - \theta_4)$; $\omega_3 = \omega_2\cdot a\cdot\sin(\theta_4 - \theta_2)/(b\cdot\sin(\theta_3 - \theta_4))$, $\omega_4 = \omega_2\cdot a\cdot\sin(\theta_3 - \theta_2)/(c\cdot\sin(\theta_3 - \theta_4))$; $\alpha$ from the second derivative at constant $\omega_2$ |
| Grashof class and transmission angle | $s + l < p + q$ (crank-rocker, double-crank or double-rocker by the shortest link), = at the change point, > non-Grashof; transmission angle $\cos\mu = (b^2 + c^2 - \ell^2)/(2bc)$ folded to 0 … 90°; toggle where $\ell = b + c$ or $\lvert b - c\rvert$ |
| Slider-crank position | $x = r\cdot\cos\theta + \sigma\cdot\sqrt{(l^2 - (r\cdot\sin\theta - e)^2)}$ ($\sigma$ = +1 open, −1 crossed); $dx/d\theta = -r\cdot\sin\theta - r\cdot\cos\theta\cdot(r\cdot\sin\theta - e)/(x - r\cdot\cos\theta)$; dead centres where crank and rod are collinear; $\mu$ = 90° − \|rod angle to the slide line\| |
| Input torque by virtual work | $T_{in}\cdot\omega_{in} = \Sigma F\cdot v$; four-bar $T_{in} = (T_L + J\cdot\alpha_4)\cdot\omega_4/\omega_2$; slider $T_{in} = (m\cdot a + F_L)\cdot dx/d\theta$; RMS torque and mean power over the sweep by Simpson's rule |
| Mechanism forces | four-bar tangential pin force $P = (T_L + J\cdot\alpha_4)/c$, coupler (and crank-pin) force P/sin μ; slider slide-direction force $F_x = m\cdot a + F_L$, rod force $F_x/\cos\theta_3$, guide reaction $F_x\cdot\tan\theta_3$; cam contact normal F/cos φ |
| Assembly limits | four-bar toggles at $\cos\theta_2 = (d^2 + a^2 - \ell^2)/(2ad)$, $\ell = b + c$ or $\lvert b - c\rvert$; slider $\sin\theta = (e \pm l)/r$. The sweep is cut at them and, driven at constant speed into one, the unbounded peaks are not reported |
| Loop closure | $\lvert a\cdot e^{j\theta_2} + b\cdot e^{j\theta_3} - c\cdot e^{j\theta_4} - d\rvert$ (slider: $\lvert r\cdot e^{j\theta} + l\cdot e^{j\theta_3} - (x + j\cdot e)\rvert$) asserted below 1e-9 mm at every step |
| Cam, per segment with $x = (\theta - \theta_0)/\beta$ | rise $s = s_0 + h\cdot f(x)$, return $s = s_0 - h\cdot f(x)$; cycloidal $f = x - \sin(2\pi x)/(2\pi)$; 3-4-5 $f = 10x^3 - 15x^4 + 6x^5$; 4-5-6-7 $f = 35x^4 - 84x^5 + 70x^6 - 20x^7$; modified trapezoid from its acceleration pieces ($C_v = 2$, $C_a = 8\pi/(\pi + 2)$, $C_j = 32\pi^2/(\pi + 2)$) |

| WHAT IT CALCULATES | RELATION |
|---|---|
| Cam SVAJ at constant ω | $v = \omega \cdot s'$, $a = \omega^2 \cdot s''$, $j = \omega^3 \cdot s'''$ ($' = d/d\theta$); peak coefficients $C_v = \max f'$, $C_a = \max \lvert f'' \rvert$, $C_j = \max \lvert f''' \rvert$, so $v_{pk} = C_v \cdot h \cdot \omega / \beta$ |
| Pressure angle (roller, offset e, $R_p = R_b + R_r$) | $\varphi = \arctan[(s' - e)/(\sqrt{(R_p^2 - e^2)} + s)]$, which for e = 0 is $\arctan[s'/(R_p + s)]$; the base circle that holds $\varphi \le \varphi_{max}$ has $R_{p,req} = \sqrt{(s_o,req^2 + e^2)}$ with $s_o,req = \max(\lvert s' - e \rvert / \tan \varphi_{max} - s)$ |
| Radius of curvature of the pitch curve $P(\theta) = Rot(-\theta) \cdot (e, \sqrt{(R_p^2 - e^2)} + s)$ | $\rho = \lvert P' \rvert^3 / (P' \times P'')$, convex where positive; undercut where $\rho_{min} \le R_r$ (FAIL), none where the curve is nowhere convex; flat-faced follower: signed profile radius $\rho = R_b + s + s''$, the minimum of which must stay above zero (FAIL at or below) and the face must reach $\lvert s' \rvert$; the cam turns counter-clockwise with the follower axis at +x offset e |
| Cam follower force $F = m \cdot a + k \cdot s + F_{pre} + F_{ext}$ (the follower leaves the cam where F < 0); input torque by virtual work $T = F \cdot s'$ ($T \cdot \omega = F \cdot v$) | |

Basis: Position, velocity and acceleration analysis; transmission angle; Grashof condition[1](Ch. 4, 6, 7); Loop-closure position analysis; velocity and acceleration of planar linkages[2](Ch. 4–6).

## 2. Inputs

| SYMBOL | DESCRIPTION | VALUE | UNIT | SOURCE | VALID RANGE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| mode | Kind of mechanism | Cam | | spec: Indexing station IDX-12 §2 rev A | any |
| $e_{off}$ | Offset e: slide line above the crank centre (slider-crank; blank: 0); cam follower axis offset, with the cam turning counter-clockwise and the follower axis at +x: positive e reduces the pressure angle where ds/dθ exceeds e (the rise), negative raises it | 10 | mm | drawing: IDX-12-CAM rev A | -1000 … 1000 mm |
| steps | Intervals N of the table (N + 1 rows, a whole number, at most 3600; the peaks do not depend on it) | 72 | | assumption: 5° table step. | 4 … 720 |
| $n_{in}$ | Input speed (constant) | 120 | rpm | spec: Indexing station IDX-12 §2: 120 index cycles/min rev A | 0.1 … 30000 rpm |
| follower | Follower type: roller (translating, pressure angle and undercut checked) or flat-faced (in-line) | Roller | | drawing: IDX-12-CAM rev A | any |

| SYMBOL | DESCRIPTION | VALUE | UNIT | SOURCE | VALID RANGE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rb | Base-circle radius of the cam profile $R_b$ | 40 | mm | drawing: IDX-12-CAM rev A | 1 … 1000 mm |
| $R_r$ | Roller radius $R_r$ (roller follower) | 8 | mm | drawing: IDX-12-CAM rev A | 1 … 200 mm |
| $\varphi_{max}$ | Maximum pressure angle allowed (roller follower) | 30 | ° | assumption: Usual limit for a translating roller follower; set it from your design rule. | 5 … 45 ° |
| segs | Cam segments: rise, dwell or return, with motion law, angle and lift; the angles add to 360° and the rises equal the returns | 4 row(s) | | spec: Indexing station IDX-12 §2.3 motion table rev A | any |
| $m_f$ | Follower mass (all moving parts that follow the cam) | 0.2 | kg | assumption: Example: follower arm, roller and tooling; take it from the CAD mass properties. | 0 … 1000 kg |
| $k_{sp}$ | Return spring rate (link M7 rate k) | 5 | N/mm | assumption: Example return-spring rate; link the rate k of the M7 spring sheet. | 0 … 1000 N/mm |
| $F_{pre}$ | Spring preload at the base circle (link an M7 force) | 20 | N | assumption: Example preload at the base circle; link a force of the M7 spring sheet. | 0 … 100000 N |
| $F_{ext}$ | External load on the follower, positive against the rise | 0 | N | assumption: No external load on the follower in this example. | -100000 … 100000 N |

| TABLE ROW | VALUES |
|---|---|
| segs[1] | kind = Rise; law = Cycloidal; beta = 120°; h = 20 mm |
| segs[2] | kind = Dwell; law = —; beta = 60°; h = 0 mm |
| segs[3] | kind = Return; law = 3-4-5 polynomial; beta = 120°; h = 20 mm |
| segs[4] | kind = Dwell; law = —; beta = 60°; h = 0 mm |

## 3. Assumptions

A1. Rigid links, a planar mechanism with one degree of freedom, no joint clearance and no friction; the input turns at a constant speed. (Scope limits of the model.)
A2. The position is the closed-form solution of the vector loop; the open and crossed circuits are the two branches ($\theta_4 = \varphi - \gamma$ and $\varphi + \gamma$ for the four-bar, $\sigma = +1$ and $-1$ for the slider) and the sweep stays on the chosen branch; for a change-point linkage (parallelogram, deltoid) the circuit is named at a reference angle

that does not depend on the sweep (the middle of the first interval between change points in 0 ... 2π, π/2 when there are none), so the label at a crank angle means the same motion on every turn; only the true change points (all four links collinear, $\theta_2 = 0$ or π) flip the branch, and it is followed by continuity through them inside the sweep. A linkage with one change point per turn (a kite) repeats every 720° and a sweep of more than one turn warns. Angles at which the linkage cannot be assembled, or at a toggle where the velocity system is singular, are left out of the table and counted. (Norton, Design of Machinery, position analysis of the four-bar and the offset slider-crank.)
A3. Input torque is by virtual work from the output load and the inertia of the output element only (four-bar: the output link's moment of inertia about its pivot; slider: the slider mass); the crank and the coupler or connecting rod are massless. (No link-inertia or gravity terms: add the link masses to the output element for a first allowance.)
A4. The peaks (speeds, accelerations, torque, transmission angle, swing) are those of the continuous motion over the swept range, found by a dense scan refined by golden section; the printed table (steps N, up to 3600) only samples it. (Peaks do not depend on the table's step count.)
A5. Cam: a translating follower on a cam turning at constant speed; the follower mass, a linear return spring (rate and preload at the base circle, for example linked from M7) and a constant external load make the force the cam must apply, $F = m \cdot a + k \cdot s + F_{pre} + F_{ext}$; contact is lost where it falls below zero. The segment table must add to 360° and close; pressure angle and undercut are checked for the roller follower ($R_p = R_b + R_r$), the positive profile radius for the flat-faced one. (Norton, Design of Machinery, cam design: the four classical laws, pressure angle and radius of curvature.)
A6. Follower force (four-bar: the tangential force at the output pin, $(T_L + J \cdot \alpha_4)/c$; slider: the slide-direction force $m \cdot a + F_L$; cam: the axial force) is the force the mechanism must apply to the output element. The force in the coupler ($F_{pin,pk}$) is the tangential force over sin μ; in the connecting rod it is the slide-direction force over cos $\theta_3$, and the guide reaction is that force times tan $\theta_3$; the roller contact normal force is F/cos φ. Crank, coupler and rod are massless two-force members. (Rigid body, frictionless.)
A7. When the sweep meets an assembly limit (a toggle of a four-bar, the rod perpendicular to the slide line of a slider-crank) the sweep is cut there and, because the speed, acceleration, torque and forces at constant input speed are unbounded at the limit, they are not reported; the limit angles are listed. A change-point four-bar (parallelogram, deltoid) is continued through its singular position on the same branch by continuity (γ changes sign there), but its speeds and torques next to the singular position are not reported. (Closed-form limit angles: $\ell = b + c$ or $|b - c|$ (four-bar), $|r \cdot \sin\theta - e| = l$ (slider).)
A8. Into F1 and E1: $output_{motion}$ is a kinematic proxy at constant crank speed, not the cylinder speed of an actuated linkage. For E1 use the peak $input_{torque}$ for the peak check and $T_{rms,in}$ with $n_{in}$ for the thermal sizing; the mean power is $P_{mean}$. (Used by the actuated-linkage and mechanism-review packs.)
A9. steps (Intervals N of the table (N + 1 rows, a whole number, at most 3600; the peaks do not depend on it)) is taken as 72. (5° table step.)
A10. $\varphi_{max}$ (Maximum pressure angle allowed (roller follower)) is taken as 30 °. (Usual limit for a translating roller follower; set it from your design rule.)
A11. $m_f$ (Follower mass (all moving parts that follow the cam)) is taken as 0.2 kg. (Example: follower arm, roller and tooling; take it from the CAD mass properties.)
A12. $k_{sp}$ (Return spring rate (link M7 rate k)) is taken as 5 N/mm. (Example return-spring rate; link the rate k of the M7 spring sheet.)
A13. $F_{pre}$ (Spring preload at the base circle (link an M7 force)) is taken as 20 N. (Example preload at the base circle; link a force of the M7 spring sheet.)
A14. $F_{ext}$ (External load on the follower, positive against the rise) is taken as 0 N. (No external load on the follower in this example.)

## 4. Working

$\theta_{sw} = \theta$ [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [0, 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, … (73 items)] deg
Table: cam angle

[16] $s_{sw} = s = s_0 + h \cdot f(\theta/\beta)$ [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [0, 0.0094867, 0.075117, 0.24921, 0.57669, 1.092, 1.8169, 2.7587, 3.91, 5.2492, 6.7418, 8.3
items)] mm
Table: follower displacement
[17] $v_{sw} = v = \omega \cdot ds/d\theta$ [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [0, 0.0040889, 0.016077, 0.035147, 0.06, 0.088942, 0.12, 0.15106, 0.18, 0.20485, 0.22392, 0
(73 items)] m/s
Table: follower velocity
[18] $a_{sw} = a = \omega^2 \cdot d^2s/d\theta^2$ [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [0, 1.1709, 2.2619, 3.1989, 3.9178, 4.3697, 4.5239, 4.3697, 3.9178, 3.1989, 2.2619, 1.1709,
m/s²
Table: follower acceleration
[19] $j_{sw} = j = \omega^3 \cdot d^3s/d\theta^3$ [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [170.55, 164.74, 147.7, 120.59, 85.273, 44.141, 1.0443e-14, -44.141, -85.273, -120.59, -147
(73 items)] m/s³
Table: follower jerk
[20] $\varphi_{sw} = \varphi = \arctan[(s' - e)/(\sqrt{(R_p^2 - e^2)} + s)]$ [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [-12.025, -11.642, -10.507, -8.6775, -6.2746, -3.4811, -0.52955, 2.3281, 4.8597, 6.8841, 8.
… (73 items)] deg
Table: pressure angle
[21] $\kappa_{sw} = \kappa = 1/\rho$ of the pitch curve (positive convex, negative concave) [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [0.020833, 0.01767, 0.01465, 0.011975, 0.0098989, 0.0086679, 0.008423, 0.0091267, 0.010569,
0.012452, 0.014489, 0.016465, … (73 items)] 1/mm
Table: curvature of the pitch curve (the radius of curvature is 1/κ where κ is positive)
[22] $F_{sw} = F = m \cdot a + k \cdot s + F_{pre} + F_{ext}$ [3](kinematics)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [20, 20.282, 20.828, 21.886, 23.667, 26.334, 29.989, 34.667, 40.334, 46.886, 54.161, 61.948
items)] N
Table: follower force on the cam
[23] $T_{in,sw} = T = F \cdot ds/d\theta$ [4](work)
= 73 rows, θ from 0° to 360°
= [0, 0.0065993, 0.026647, 0.061213, 0.113, 0.18639, 0.28638, 0.41673, 0.57774, 0.76432, 0.96
… (73 items)] N·m
Table: input torque by virtual work
[24] $seg_{start}$ = Σ β of the segments before [3](kinematics)
= 4 segments
= [0, 120, 180, 300] deg
Segments: start angle
[25] $seg_{beta} = \beta$ [3](kinematics)
= 4 segments
= [120, 60, 120, 60] deg
Segments: angle
[26] $seg_{s,end}$ = s at the end of the segment [3](kinematics)
= 4 segments
= [20, 20, 0, 0] mm
Segments: displacement at the end

[27] $seg_{v,pk}$ = max |v| in the segment [3](kinematics)
= 4 segments
= [0.24, 0, 0.225, 0] m/s
Segments: peak velocity
[28] $seg_{a,pk}$ = max |a| in the segment [3](kinematics)
= 4 segments
= [4.5239, 0, 4.1569, 0] m/s²
Segments: peak acceleration
[29] $seg_{j,pk}$ = max |j| in the segment [3](kinematics)
= 4 segments
= [170.55, 0, 259.2, 0] m/s³
Segments: peak jerk
[30] lift = max s [3](kinematics)
= over the revolution
= 20 mm
Greatest follower displacement
[31] $v_{pk}$ = max |v| [3](kinematics)
= scan of each segment, refined
= 0.24 m/s
Peak follower velocity
[32] $a_{pk}$ = max |a| [3](kinematics)
= scan of each segment, refined
= 4.5239 m/s²
Peak follower acceleration
[33] $j_{pk}$ = max |j| [3](kinematics)
= scan of each segment, refined
= 259.2 m/s³
Peak follower jerk
[34] $F_{max}$ = max F [3](kinematics)
= scan of each segment, refined
= 120 N
Greatest follower force on the cam
[35] $F_{min}$ = min F [3](kinematics)
= scan of each segment, refined
= 20 N
Smallest follower force on the cam (negative: the follower leaves the cam)
[36] $\varphi_{max,pk}$ = max |φ| [3](kinematics)
= scan of each segment, refined
= 26.596 deg
Largest pressure angle
[37] $Rb_{min,phi}$ = $R_b$ that keeps φ at its limit [3](kinematics)
= $s_0$ = max(|s' − e|/tan $\varphi_{max}$ − s), $R_p$ = √($s_0^2$ + $e^2$)
= 32.963 mm
Smallest base-circle radius that keeps the pressure angle within its limit (roller follower)
[38] $\rho_{min}$ = 1/$\kappa_{max}$ [3](kinematics)
= pitch curve
= 44.681 mm
Smallest radius of curvature of the pitch curve
[39] $u_{rho}$ = $R_r$ / $\rho_{min}$ [3](kinematics)
= 8 mm / 44.681 mm
= 0.17905
Roller radius against the smallest radius of curvature (undercut at 1 or more)

[40] $u_{phi} = \varphi_{max} / \varphi_{allowed}$ [3](kinematics)
= 26.596° / 30°
= 0.88653
Largest pressure angle against the allowed one
[41] $input_{torque} = max |F \cdot ds/d\theta|$ [4](work)
= virtual work, scan of each segment, refined
= 1.5345 N·m
Peak input torque by virtual work (mech.input_torque)
[42] $output_{motion} = max |v|$ [3](kinematics)
= follower
= 0.24 m/s
Peak follower velocity (mech.output_motion)
[43] $peak_{accel} = max |a|$ [3](kinematics)
= follower
= 4.5239 m/s²
Peak follower acceleration (mech.peak_accel)
[44] $follower_{force} = max |F|$ [3](kinematics)
= $m \cdot a + k \cdot s + F_{pre} + F_{ext}$
= 120 N
Peak axial force of the follower on the cam (mech.follower_force)
[45] $F_{pin,pk} = max |F|/\cos \varphi$ [3](kinematics)
= roller contact normal force
= 121.33 N
Peak contact normal force on the cam, the load on the cam shaft's bearings (mech.F_pin_pk → M4, M5)
[46] $F_{spring,max} = k \cdot h + F_{pre}$ [3](kinematics)
= spring force at full lift, no inertia
= 120 N
Spring force at full lift (mech.F_spring_max → M7 working force)
[47] $T_{rms,in} = \sqrt{(mean\ T^2)}$ [4](work)
= Simpson per segment
= 0.69759 N·m
RMS input torque over the cam revolution (mech.T_rms_in → E1 thermal sizing)
[48] $P_{mean} = \omega \cdot mean(T)$ [4](work)
= Simpson per segment
= -4.375e-10 W
Mean input power over the cam revolution (mech.P_mean)
[49] $f_{in} = n_{in} / 60$
= rpm to Hz
= 2 Hz
Cam-shaft frequency, for the spring surge check of M7 (mech.f_in)

## 5. Results

| SYMBOL | VALUE | DESCRIPTION |
|---|---|---|
| $input_{torque}$ | 1.534 N·m | Peak input torque by virtual work (mech.input_torque) |
| $output_{motion}$ | 0.2400 m/s | Peak follower velocity (mech.output_motion) |
| $peak_{accel}$ | 4.524 m/s² | Peak follower acceleration (mech.peak_accel) |
| $follower_{force}$ | 120 N | Peak axial force of the follower on the cam (mech.follower_force) |
| $F_{pin,pk}$ | 121.3 N | Peak contact normal force on the cam, the load on the cam shaft's bearings (mech.F_pin_pk → M4, M5) |

| SYMBOL | VALUE | DESCRIPTION |
|---|---|---|
| $T_{rms,in}$ | 0.6976 N·m | RMS input torque over the cam revolution (mech.T_rms_in → E1 thermal sizing) |
| $n_{in}$ | 120 rpm | Cam-shaft speed, passed through for E1's load speed (mech.n_in) |
| $f_{in}$ | 2 Hz | Cam-shaft frequency, for the spring surge check of M7 (mech.f_in) |
| $P_{mean}$ | -4.375e-10 W | Mean input power over the cam revolution (mech.P_mean) |
| lift | 20 mm | Greatest follower displacement |
| $F_{spring,max}$ | 120 N | Spring force at full lift (mech.F_spring_max → M7 working force) |
| $\theta_{sw}$ | [0, 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, … (73 items)] deg | Table: cam angle |
| $s_{sw}$ | [0, 0.0094867, 0.075117, 0.24921, 0.57669, 1.092, 1.8169, 2.7587, 3.91, 5.2492, 6.7418, 8.3428, … (73 items)] mm | Table: follower displacement |
| $v_{sw}$ | [0, 0.0040889, 0.016077, 0.035147, 0.06, 0.088942, 0.12, 0.15106, 0.18, 0.20485, 0.22392, 0.23591, … (73 items)] m/s | Table: follower velocity |
| $a_{sw}$ | [0, 1.1709, 2.2619, 3.1989, 3.9178, 4.3697, 4.5239, 4.3697, 3.9178, 3.1989, 2.2619, 1.1709, … (73 items)] m/s² | Table: follower acceleration |
| $j_{sw}$ | [170.55, 164.74, 147.7, 120.59, 85.273, 44.141, 1.0443e-14, -44.141, -85.273, -120.59, -147.7, -164.74, … (73 items)] m/s³ | Table: follower jerk |
| $\varphi_{sw}$ | [-12.025, -11.642, -10.507, -8.6775, -6.2746, -3.4811, -0.52955, 2.3281, 4.8597, 6.8841, 8.2863, 9.0164, … (73 items)] deg | Table: pressure angle |

| SYMBOL | VALUE | DESCRIPTION |
|---|---|---|
| $\kappa_{sw}$ | [0.020833, 0.01767, 0.01465, 0.011975, 0.0098989, 0.0086679, 0.008423, 0.0091267, 0.010569, 0.012452, 0.014489, 0.016465, … (73 items)] 1/mm | Table: curvature of the pitch curve (the radius of curvature is 1/κ where κ is positive) |
| $F_{sw}$ | [20, 20.282, 20.828, 21.886, 23.667, 26.334, 29.989, 34.667, 40.334, 46.886, 54.161, 61.948, … (73 items)] N | Table: follower force on the cam |
| $T_{in,sw}$ | [0, 0.0065993, 0.026647, 0.061213, 0.113, 0.18639, 0.28638, 0.41673, 0.57774, 0.76432, 0.96511, 1.163, … (73 items)] N·m | Table: input torque by virtual work |
| $seg_{start}$ | [0, 120, 180, 300] deg | Segments: start angle |
| $seg_{beta}$ | [120, 60, 120, 60] deg | Segments: angle |
| $seg_{s,end}$ | [20, 20, 0, 0] mm | Segments: displacement at the end |
| $seg_{v,pk}$ | [0.24, 0, 0.225, 0] m/s | Segments: peak velocity |
| $seg_{a,pk}$ | [4.5239, 0, 4.1569, 0] m/s² | Segments: peak acceleration |
| $seg_{j,pk}$ | [170.55, 0, 259.2, 0] m/s³ | Segments: peak jerk |
| $seg_{law}$ | "1: rise (Cycloidal); 2: dwell; 3: return (3-4-5 polynomial); 4: dwell" | Segments: kind and motion law |
| $v_{pk}$ | 0.2400 m/s | Peak follower velocity |
| $a_{pk}$ | 4.524 m/s² | Peak follower acceleration |
| $j_{pk}$ | 259.2 m/s³ | Peak follower jerk |
| $F_{max}$ | 120 N | Greatest follower force on the cam |
| $F_{min}$ | 20 N | Smallest follower force on the cam (negative: the follower leaves the cam) |
| $\varphi_{max,pk}$ | 26.60° | Largest pressure angle |
| $Rb_{min,phi}$ | 32.96 mm | Smallest base-circle radius that keeps the pressure angle within its limit (roller follower) |
| $\rho_{min}$ | 44.68 mm | Smallest radius of curvature of the pitch curve |
| $u_{rho}$ | 0.18 | Roller radius against the smallest radius of curvature |
| $u_{phi}$ | 0.89 | Largest pressure angle against the allowed one (governing) |

## 6. Checks (governing first)

| RESULT | CHECK | DEMAND | CAPACITY | UTILISATION | REF |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| PASS | Pressure angle $\varphi_{max}$ within the allowed maximum | $u_{phi}$ = 0.89 | $u_{phi}$ ≤ 1 | 0.89 | [3](kinematics) |
| PASS | No undercut: $\rho_{min}$ of the pitch curve exceeds the roller radius | $\rho_{min}$ = 44.681 mm | > 8 mm | — | [3](kinematics) |
| PASS | Follower stays on the cam: $F_{min}$ ≥ 0 | $F_{min}$ = 20 N | ≥ 0 N | — | [3](kinematics) |

## 7. Applicability

None.

## 8. Verification

Template mech.mechanism@1.2.2 Content hash ec0fa964408ca211 Engine calc-engine/1.0.0
Known-answer cases passed 16/16 Test run 2026-10-23 12:00 UTC TempestOS 0.26.0

## 9. References

1. Norton, Design of Machinery.
2. Budynas RG, Nisbett JK. Shigley's Mechanical Engineering Design. 11th ed. McGraw-Hill Education; 2020.
3. Cam follower.
4. Virtual.